CASE STUDY: CREATION OF A STUDENT-DRIVEN RADIO TALK SHOW TO ANSWER CYBERSECURITY QUESTIONS AND CONCERNS TO BOOST POWER SKILLS

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Introduction

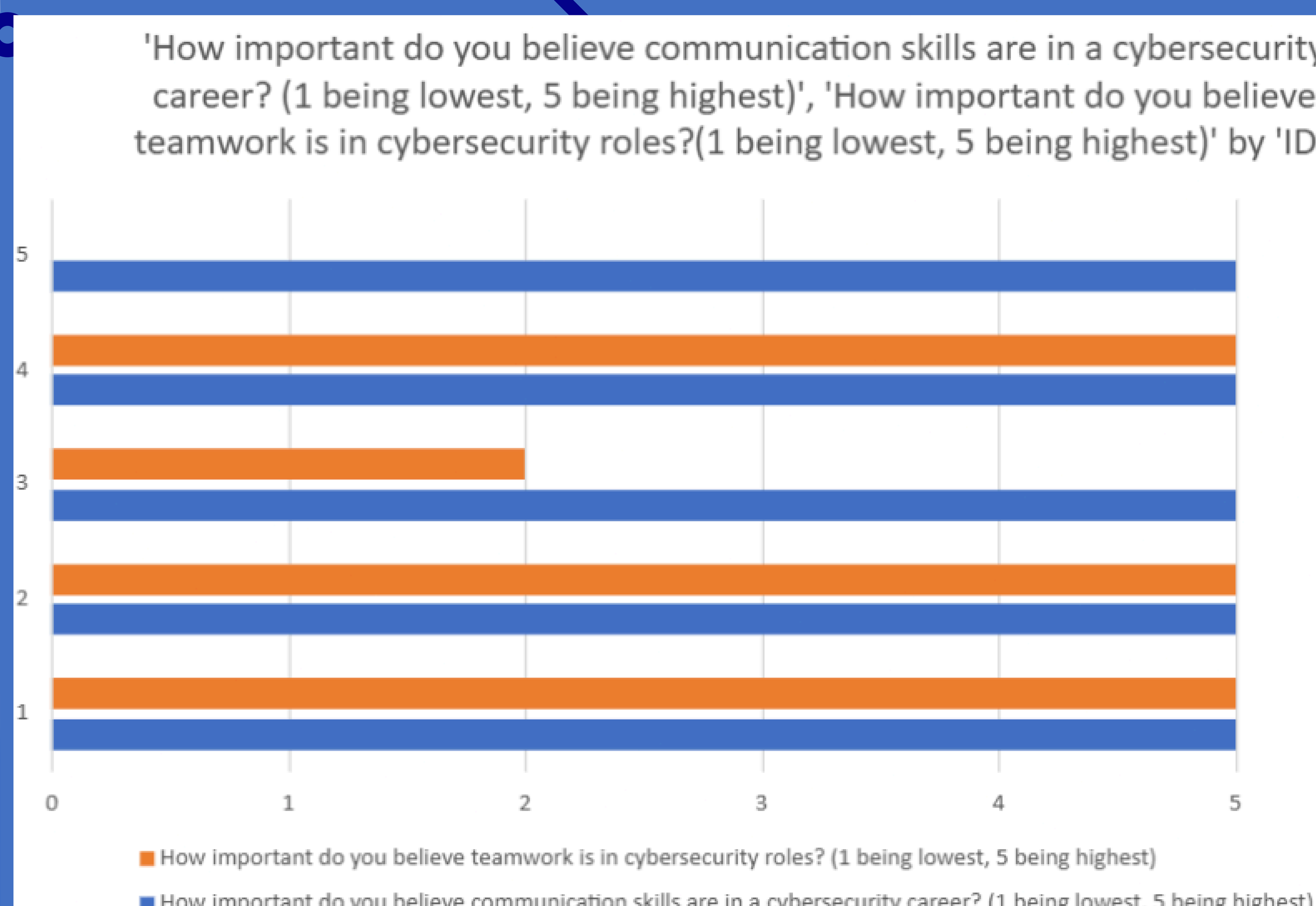
As cyber threats increase, demand for cybersecurity professionals continues to grow. While technical skills remain essential, employers also prioritize communication, collaboration, and teamwork. Professionals must clearly convey risks, work across teams during incidents, and balance security with business needs. Those who combine technical and interpersonal skills are better prepared for success. Additionally, cybersecurity awareness—such as recognizing phishing, using strong passwords, enabling multi-factor authentication, and reporting suspicious activity—is key to reducing human-related risks.

Methods

The C.Y.B.E.R. radio show was a student-led experiential project conducted in Spring 2026 at Kean University, involving five undergraduate cybersecurity students who planned and delivered a live 30-minute broadcast on cybersecurity awareness. Under faculty guidance, students developed content, assigned roles, rehearsed responses, and gathered audience questions through campus outreach. Data were collected from post-show reflections, survey responses, planning documents, and debrief notes to capture skill development and collaboration. Using a qualitative case study approach, researchers conducted inductive thematic analysis on these materials to identify patterns in communication, teamwork, and professional growth.

Results

Results indicate that power skills—particularly communication and teamwork—are essential for cybersecurity readiness and were strengthened through this project. Participants demonstrated improved ability to explain technical concepts, collaborate during planning and execution, and engage diverse audiences, aligning with prior research emphasizing these competencies. The student-led radio format provided an authentic, experiential setting that increased confidence, accountability, and engagement. Overall, findings suggest that media-based, peer-driven projects effectively enhance interpersonal and professional skills critical for success in cybersecurity careers.



Conclusion

This case study's main takeaway is that a student-driven cybersecurity radio show can be a powerful experiential learning vehicle for building power skills. The C.Y.B.E.R. radio project gave participants authentic opportunities to practice communication, teamwork, and professional confidence – skills that are emphasized in the literature as essential for cybersecurity careers. Students reported tangible improvements in explaining technical content, collaborating on a project, and speaking to a broad audience. In doing so, they felt better prepared to enter the workforce and appreciated how interpersonal competence complements their technical training.

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